

TESTICULAR CANCER

Cancer of the testis is one of the most commonly occurring cancers in men aged between 20 and 40. Although it is curable if discovered early, the cancer can spread to lymph nodes and to other parts of the body if not treated. Symptoms of testicular cancer include a hard, painless lump in the testis; a change in the size and appearance of the testis; or a dull ache in the scrotum. There are two main types of testicular cancer, seminoma and non-seminoma. They develop from the sperm-producing cells of the testis. As early

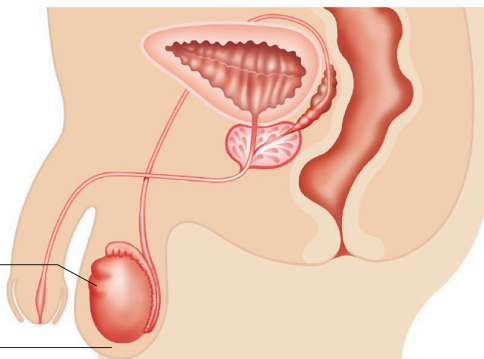
treatment of the cancer is vital and has a very high cure rate, all men should regularly examine their testes; any swellings or changes in the scrotal skin should be reported urgently. Soft lumps or painful swellings are likely to be caused by a cyst or infection, but should still be checked.

TUMOUR ON TESTIS

A tumour of this size on the outer wall of the testis would be clearly felt through the thin outer skin and layers of the scrotum.

Tumour
Tiny growth
on the testis

Scrotum



HYDROCELE

Each testis is surrounded by a double-layered membrane, which under normal conditions contains a small amount of fluid. In a hydrocele, an excessive amount of fluid forms, causing the testis to appear swollen. The condition occurs most frequently in infants and elderly people. The cause of hydrocele is not usually known, although infection, inflammation, or injury to the testis are possible triggers. A hydrocele does not usually cause any pain, but may result in a dragging sensation due to the increased size and weight of the scrotum. In younger people with hydrocele,

the condition often gets better without the need for treatment. However, if the condition is causing discomfort, the hydrocele may be surgically removed or, for those who are not fit enough for surgery, the fluid may be drained from the area using a needle and syringe.

SWOLLEN TESTIS

A hydrocele is the result of excess fluid filling the double-layered membrane that surrounds the testis; it causes the scrotum to appear swollen.

Scrotum

Testis

Fluid
Fluid accumulates
around the testis

